Training and Certification Guide

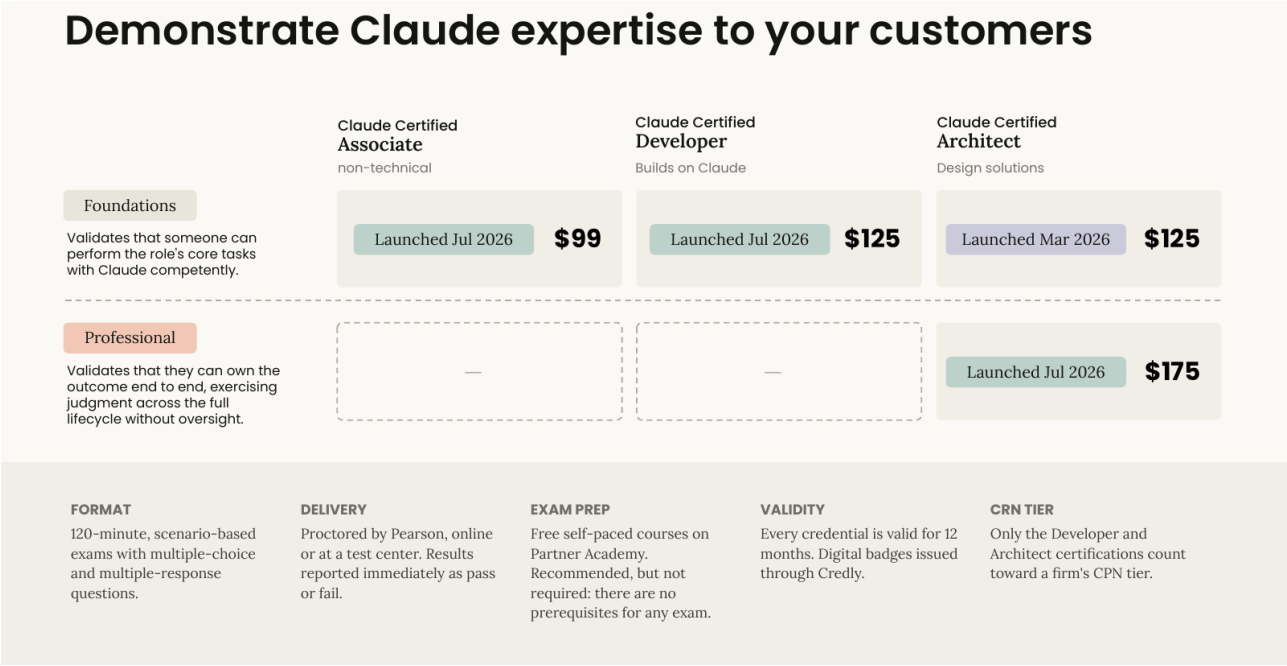
Which exams count · How many people we need · How to build the bench · Where to learn

The one rule to remember
Only **Developer** and **Architect** certifications count toward our tier. The **Associate** exam does **not**. We have **4** certified people today and need **10** for Select – so **6 more people should take a Developer or Architect exam**.

1. The four exams

Exam	Level	List price	Counts toward tier?	Best for
Claude Certified **Associate**	Foundations	$99	**No**	Foundational knowledge; useful for non-engineering roles
Claude Certified **Developer**	Foundations	$125	**Yes**	People who build with Claude
Claude Certified **Architect**	Foundations	$125	**Yes**	People who design solutions; a natural first exam for architects
Claude Certified **Architect**	Professional	$175	**Yes**	Advanced architect level

- **Price:** the Training and Certification Guidebook lists these prices; the Program Guide shows a **100% exam discount through 31 December 2026**, and our own booking showed **Free** at checkout. **Book before 31 December 2026.** The discount applies automatically – there is no code to enter.
- **Format:** 120 minutes, scenario-based, scored 100–1,000, **720 to pass**; delivered by Pearson VUE online (proctored) or at a test center; results are immediate.
- **Validity:** a certification is valid 12 months; renewal is a free non-proctored assessment on the Partner Academy.
- **Retakes:** wait 14 days after the first attempt, 30 after the second, 90 after the third; maximum four attempts per exam per rolling 12 months.
- **Eligibility:** exams are for people at accepted Claude Partner Network firms, registering with their **company-domain email**. No prerequisites; prep courses are free and recommended.
- **One person counts once** toward tier, even with several certifications. Certifications must be current and show in the Partner Hub (updates weekly).



Training and Certification Guidebook, p.6 – the four certifications, price and format.

2. How to build the bench of 10

Role in our firm	Take this exam	Why
People who build with Claude (developers, engineers)	Developer – Foundations	Counts toward tier
People who design Claude solutions (architects)	Architect – Foundations, then Professional	Counts; Foundations is a natural first exam
Managers, sales and other non-technical roles	Associate (optional)	**Does not count** toward tier – do not use it to fill the 10

- ☐ **Name the ten** people (from the 90-day plan, weeks 1–2). Include the 4 already certified.
- ☐ Assign the free prep: Partner Academy courses (anthropic-partners.skilljar.com) – start with the CPN Learning Path, then the role path.
- ☐ Book each exam using the step-by-step Exam Booking Guide in this folder. Each person uses their own company email.
- ☐ Track progress monthly in the Hub (Current Tier panel).
- ☐ Build certification into onboarding and bench time; consider a team exam day and recognition for passes.

3. Where people learn

Resource	What it is	Access
Partner Academy	Free courses and prep for every role; also hosts exam registration	anthropic-partners.skilljar.com – sign in with company email
Role pathways (Training Playbook)	10 role paths (data engineer, data scientist, ML engineer, software developer, platform / cloud, solutions architect, data analyst, project manager, product manager, client principal) each with courses, a build project and an exam	Portal: Partner Training and Certification Playbook
Partner Basecamp	Two-day in-person program (San Francisco and London); needs prior hands-on Claude Code experience; invite only	Ask via PAM AI; partner-basecamp@anthropic.com

Resource	What it is	Access
Claude Code partner badge	Eight courses and a capstone; free	Via the Academy (path/partner-badge-claude-code)
Free Anthropic courses	Claude Code in Action; Introduction to Model Context Protocol; Building with the Claude API; Introduction to agent skills	Listed in the portal content library
Webinars, docs, blog	Product news and how-tos	docs.claude.com; anthropic.com/webinars; claude.com/blog

4. Beyond tier: the Delivery Readiness Designation (DRD)

DRD helps Anthropic match us to customer opportunities. It asks for: **10 or more active** Developer / Architect certified people, **three documented deployments** (Claude Code or Cowork), **one contactable customer reference**, and evidence across six areas (environment and deployment, enablement, governance and administration, adoption and change management, troubleshooting and escalation, security posture). Certified is the minimum tier named; completing enablement does not automatically award it. Use the portal's "04 Practice self-check" every 30 days and email Partner Operations when ready.

5. Documents for the training lead

Document (portal name)	Use it for
Partner Training and Certification Guidebook (listed twice)	Exam prices, rules, 5-step registration, role pages
Partner Training and Certification Playbook v1.1	Role-by-role curriculum (26 pages)
02 Skills and certification for your Claude bench	13-page short version of the Playbook – start here
01 Building your Claude practice	Roles, team shape, DRD, 90-day ramp
04 Practice self-check	Scorecard every 30 days; DRD prerequisites
03 Measuring customer value on a Claude activation	Proving value (shared with Delivery)
CPN Partner Sandbox Guide	**Not for us now** – Select and above only

6. Small errors in the portal documents

- The Training Guidebook p.10 labels the Architect Professional card "Developer – Foundations" (typo).
- Account / domain contact is partner-support@ in some documents and partner-success@ in others.
- Exam prices appear only in the Guidebook – check each exam page for the current price.